Math 220: Mathematical Reasoning and Proof
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All Solutions

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Solutions 1: Introduction to course. First proof

Solutions to appear after the assignment is due.

1. Using the definitions of 'divides" and 'even", explain why 0 is even. Explain why 7 divides 0, but 0 does not divide 7.

   Solution. Recall that an integer a is *even* if there exists an integer k such that $a = 2k$. Since $0 = 2 \cdot 0$ and 0 is an integer, it follows that 0 is even.

   Recall also that, for integers a and b, we say that *a divides b* if there exists an integer k such that $b = ak$. Since $0 = 7 \cdot 0$, there exists an integer k, namely $k = 0$, such that $0 = 7k$. Therefore, $7 \mid 0$.

   On the other hand, if 0 divided 7, then there would be an integer k such that $7 = 0 \cdot k$. But $0 \cdot k = 0$ for every integer k, so this would imply that $7 = 0$, which is false. Therefore, $0 \nmid 7$.

2. Suppose that n is an even integer, and let m be any integer. Prove that nm is even.

   Solution. Since n is even, there exists an integer k such that $n = 2k$. Multiplying by m, we obtain

   $$nm = (2k)m = 2(km).$$

   Because k and m are integers, their product km is an integer. Thus nm is twice an integer, and we conclude that nm is even.

3. Suppose that n and m are odd integers. Prove that $n + m$ is an even integer.

   Solution. Since n and m are odd, there exist integers a and b such that $n = 2a + 1$ and $m = 2b + 1$. Therefore,

   $$n + m = (2a + 1) + (2b + 1) = 2a + 2b + 2 = 2(a + b + 1).$$

   Since a and b are integers, $a + b + 1$ is an integer. Thus $n + m$ is twice an integer, and we conclude that $n + m$ is even.

Solutions 2: Logic. "Direct" proofs

1. Write the negation of each of the following statements.

   Solution.

   (a) All triangles are isosceles.
   Negation: There exists a triangle that is not isosceles.

   (b) Every door in the building was locked.
   Negation: There exists a door in the building that was not locked.

   (c) Some even numbers are multiples of three.
   Negation: No even number is a multiple of three.
   Equivalently: Every even number is not a multiple of three.

   (d) Every real number is less than 100.
   Negation: There exists a real number that is greater than or equal to 100.

   (e) Every integer is positive or negative.
   Negation: There exists an integer that is neither positive nor negative.

   (f) If f is a polynomial function, then f is continuous at 0.
   Negation: f is a polynomial function and f is not continuous at 0.

   (g) If $x^2 > 0$, then $x > 0$.
   Negation:
   $$x^2 > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad x \leq 0.$$

   (h) There exists a $y \in \mathbf{R}$ such that $xy = 1$.
   Negation: For every $y \in \mathbf{R}$,
   $$xy \neq 1.$$

   (i) $(2 > 1)$ and $(\forall x, x^2 > 0)$.
   Negation:
   $$(2 \leq 1) \quad \text{or} \quad (\exists x \text{ such that } x^2 \leq 0).$$

   (j) $\forall \epsilon > 0$, $\exists \delta > 0$ such that if $|x| < \delta$, then $|f(x)| < \epsilon$.
   Negation: There exists an $\epsilon > 0$ such that for every $\delta > 0$, $|x| < \delta$ and $|f(x)| \geq \epsilon$.

   The following is also correct:

   There exists an $\epsilon > 0$ such that for every $\delta > 0$, there exists an x such that

   $$|x| < \delta \qquad \text{and} \qquad |f(x)| \geq \epsilon.$$

2. Write the converse, contrapositive, and negation of each of the following implications.

   Solution.

   (a) If a quadrilateral is a rectangle, then it has two pairs of parallel sides.
   Converse: If a quadrilateral has two pairs of parallel sides, then it is a rectangle.
   Contrapositive: If a quadrilateral does not have two pairs of parallel sides, then it is not a rectangle.
   Negation: There exists a quadrilateral that is a rectangle but does not have two pairs of parallel sides.

(b)

$$(P \wedge \neg Q) \Rightarrow R.$$

Converse:

$$R \Rightarrow (P \wedge \neg Q).$$

Contrapositive:

$$\neg R \Rightarrow \neg(P \wedge \neg Q).$$

Equivalently,

$$\neg R \Rightarrow (\neg P \vee Q).$$

Negation:

$$(P \wedge \neg Q) \wedge \neg R.$$

(c)

$$P \Rightarrow (R \Rightarrow \forall x,\ Q(x)).$$

Converse:

$$(R \Rightarrow \forall x,\ Q(x)) \Rightarrow P.$$

Contrapositive:

$$\neg(R \Rightarrow \forall x,\ Q(x)) \Rightarrow \neg P.$$

Equivalently,

$$(R \wedge \exists x \text{ such that } \neg Q(x)) \Rightarrow \neg P.$$

Negation:

$$P \wedge \neg(R \Rightarrow \forall x,\ Q(x)).$$

Equivalently,

$$P \wedge R \wedge \exists x \text{ such that } \neg Q(x).$$

3. Let P and Q be statements. Write the truth table for

   (a) $(\neg P) \vee Q$

   (b) $((\neg P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge \neg Q) \Rightarrow P$

Solution.

(a)

P	Q	$\neg P$	$(\neg P) \vee Q$
T	T	F	T
T	F	F	F
F	T	T	T
F	F	T	T

(b)

P	Q	$\neg P$	$\neg P \Rightarrow Q$	$(\neg P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge \neg Q$	$((\neg P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge \neg Q) \Rightarrow P$
T	T	F	T	F	T
T	F	F	T	T	T
F	T	T	T	F	T
F	F	T	F	F	T

4. Are the statements $(P \vee Q) \wedge R$ and $P \vee (Q \wedge R)$ equivalent? If so, give a proof. If not, explain why by giving a counterexample.

   Solution.

   They are not equivalent. For example, suppose $P = T$, $Q = F$, $R = F$. Then $(P \vee Q) \wedge R = (T \vee F) \wedge F = T \wedge F = F$, while $P \vee (Q \wedge R) = T \vee (F \wedge F) = T$. Thus the two statements can have different truth values, so they are not equivalent.

5. Let P and Q be statements.

   (a) Prove that $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$ is equivalent to $P \wedge \neg Q$.

   Solution.

   We can prove this using a truth table:

P	Q	$\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$	$P \wedge \neg Q$
T	T	F	F
T	F	T	T
F	T	F	F
F	F	F	F

   The last two columns are identical. Therefore, $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$ and $P \wedge \neg Q$ are equivalent.

   (b) Prove that $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$ is *not* equivalent to $\neg P \wedge Q$.

   Solution.

   It is enough to find a choice of P and Q for which the two statements have different truth values.
   Suppose $P = F$ and $Q = T$. Then $P \Rightarrow Q$ is true, so $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q) = F$. On the other hand, $\neg P \wedge Q = T \wedge T = T$. Thus the two statements are not equivalent.

   (c) Give an example of statements P and Q such that $\neg P \Rightarrow \neg Q$ is true and $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$ is false.

   Solution.

   For example, let

   $$P = \text{“}2 > 1\text{”} \qquad \text{and} \qquad Q = \text{“}3 > 2\text{”}.$$

   Both P and Q are true.
   Thus $\neg P$ is false, so $\neg P \Rightarrow \neg Q$ is true.
   Also, $P \Rightarrow Q$ is true, and hence $\neg(P \Rightarrow Q)$ is false.

6. Suppose that n is an odd integer. Prove that n^2 is an odd integer.

   Solution.

   Since n is odd, there exists an integer k such that $n = 2k + 1$. Therefore,

   $$\begin{aligned} n^2 &= (2k+1)^2 \\ &= 4k^2 + 4k + 1 \\ &= 2(2k^2 + 2k) + 1. \end{aligned}$$

   Since k is an integer, $2k^2 + 2k$ is an integer. Thus n^2 can be written in the form $2\ell + 1$ for some integer ℓ. Therefore n^2 is odd.

7. Prove that if n^2 is even, then n is even.

   Solution.

   We prove the statement by contraposition.

   The contrapositive is:

If n is not even, then n^2 is not even.

Suppose that n is not even. Since n is an integer, n must therefore be odd. By the previous problem, if n is odd, then n^2 is odd. In particular, n^2 is not even.

Thus the contrapositive is true. Therefore the original statement is true: if n^2 is even, then n is even.

8. Prove that m is even if and only if $m^2 + 6$ is even.

Solution.

We prove both directions.

First suppose that m is even. Then there exists an integer k such that $m = 2k$. Therefore $m^2+6 = (2k)^2+6 = 4k^2 + 6 = 2(2k^2 + 3)$. Since $2k^2 + 3$ is an integer, $m^2 + 6$ is even.

Conversely, suppose that $m^2 + 6$ is even. Then there exists an integer k such that $m^2 + 6 = 2k$. Then $m^2 = 2k - 6 = 2(k - 6)$. Since $k - 6$ is an integer, m^2 is even. By the previous homework problem, we conclude that m is even.

Solutions 3: More "Direct" proofs; proof by cases

1. Prove that for all $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and for $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, $a - 1$ divides $a^n - 1$.

   Solution. If $n = 0$, then $a^n - 1 = 1 - 1 = 0 = (a - 1) \cdot 0$, so $a - 1 \mid a^n - 1$.

   Now suppose $n \geq 1$. We use the factorization

   $$a^n - 1 = (a - 1)(a^{n-1} + a^{n-2} + \cdots + a + 1).$$

   The expression in the second set of parentheses is an integer, so by the definition of divisibility, $a-1 \mid a^n-1$.

2. Suppose that $a \mid b$. Prove that for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, $a^n \mid b^n$.

   Solution. Since $a \mid b$, there is an integer k such that $b = ak$. Raising both sides to the nth power gives

   $$b^n = (ak)^n = a^n k^n.$$

   Since k^n is an integer, this shows that $a^n \mid b^n$.

3. Suppose that there exists an integer $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ such that $a \mid b^n$. Is it true that $a \mid b$? Prove or disprove your answer.

   Solution. The statement is **false**. For example, take $a = 4$, $b = 2$, and $n = 2$. Then $b^n = 2^2 = 4$, so $4 \mid 2^2$. However, $4 \nmid 2$. Thus it is possible for $a \mid b^n$ even though $a \nmid b$.

4. Prove that for all integers n, n and $n + 1$ have no common divisors other than ± 1.

   Solution. Suppose that d is a common divisor of n and $n + 1$. Then there are integers r and s such that $n = dr$ and $n + 1 = ds$. Subtracting these equations gives $1 = (n + 1) - n = d(s - r)$. Thus $d \mid 1$. The only integer divisors of 1 are 1 and -1, so $d = \pm 1$. Therefore n and $n + 1$ have no common divisors other than ± 1.

5. Prove that the product of three consecutive integers is divisible by 6.

   Solution. Let the three consecutive integers be n, $n + 1$, and $n + 2$. Among any two consecutive integers, one is even. Therefore at least one of these three integers is even, so $2 \mid n(n + 1)(n + 2)$.

   Also, every integer has remainder 0, 1, or 2 when divided by 3. Thus among three consecutive integers, exactly one is divisible by 3. Hence $3 \mid n(n + 1)(n + 2)$.

   Since 2 and 3 are relatively prime, divisibility by both 2 and 3 implies divisibility by 6. Therefore $6 \mid n(n + 1)(n + 2)$.

6. Show that for all integers a and b, $a^2b^2(a^2 - b^2)$ is divisible by 12.

   Solution. We will show separately that the expression is divisible by 4 and by 3.

   First consider divisibility by 4. If a is even, then a^2 is divisible by 4, so the entire product is divisible by 4. The same argument works if b is even.

   The only remaining case is when both a and b are odd. Then both $a - b$ and $a + b$ are even. Since

   $$a^2 - b^2 = (a - b)(a + b),$$

   the factor $a^2 - b^2$ is divisible by 4. Thus in every case, $4 \mid a^2b^2(a^2 - b^2)$.

   Now consider divisibility by 3. If $3 \mid a$ or $3 \mid b$, then $3 \mid a^2b^2$, so the whole expression is divisible by 3.

Suppose instead that neither a nor b is divisible by 3. Then each of a and b has the form $3k+1$ or $3k-1$ for some integer k. In either case, its square has remainder 1 upon division by 3. Thus we can write $a^2 = 3r+1$ and $b^2 = 3s+1$ for some integers r, s. Therefore

$$a^2 - b^2 = (3r+1) - (3s+1) = 3(r-s),$$

so $3 \mid a^2 - b^2$. Hence in every case, $3 \mid a^2b^2(a^2-b^2)$.

Since 3 and 4 are relatively prime, divisibility by both 3 and 4 implies divisibility by 12. Therefore $12 \mid a^2b^2(a^2-b^2)$.

7. Finish the following proofs from class.

   (a) In class, when we proved that $|xy| = |x|\,|y|$, we only did the cases when $x \geq 0$. Prove that $|xy| = |x|\,|y|$ when $x < 0$.

   Solution. Assume $x < 0$. There are two cases.

   If $y \geq 0$, then $xy \leq 0$. Therefore $|xy| = -xy = (-x)y = |x|\,|y|$.

   If $y < 0$, then $xy > 0$. Therefore $|xy| = xy = (-x)(-y) = |x|\,|y|$.

   Thus in both cases, $|xy| = |x|\,|y|$.

   (b) In class, when we proved that $|x+y| \leq |x| + |y|$, we only did the cases when $x, y \geq 0$, when $x, y < 0$, and when $x \geq 0$, $y < 0$. Prove that $|x+y| \leq |x| + |y|$ when $x < 0$ and $y \geq 0$.

   Solution. Assume $x < 0$ and $y \geq 0$. Then $|x| = -x$ and $|y| = y$. There are two cases depending on the sign of $x + y$.

   If $x + y \geq 0$, then $|x+y| = x + y$. Since $x < 0$, we have $x \leq -x$, and so

   $$|x+y| = x + y \leq -x + y = |x| + |y|.$$

   If $x + y < 0$, then $|x+y| = -(x+y) = -x - y$. Since $y \geq 0$, we have $-y \leq y$, and therefore

   $$|x+y| = -x - y \leq -x + y = |x| + |y|.$$

   Thus in either case, $|x+y| \leq |x| + |y|$.

8. Consider the following statements about inequalities.

   (a) Prove that $|a-b| < c$ if and only if $b - c < a < b + c$.

   Solution. We prove both directions.

   First suppose that $|a-b| < c$. Since $|a-b| \geq 0$, this implies $c > 0$.

   If $a - b \geq 0$, then $|a-b| = a - b < c$, so $a < b + c$. Also $a \geq b$, and since $c > 0$, we have $a \geq b > b - c$. Thus $b - c < a < b + c$.

   If $a - b < 0$, then $|a-b| = b - a < c$, so $b - c < a$. Also $a < b$, and since $c > 0$, we have $a < b < b + c$. Again, $b - c < a < b + c$.

   Conversely, suppose that $b - c < a < b + c$. Because a number a lies strictly between $b - c$ and $b + c$, we must have $c > 0$.

   If $a - b \geq 0$, then $|a-b| = a - b$. From $a < b + c$, we get $a - b < c$, and hence $|a-b| < c$.

   If $a - b < 0$, then $|a-b| = b - a$. From $b - c < a$, we get $b - a < c$, and hence $|a-b| < c$.

   Therefore $|a-b| < c$ if and only if $b - c < a < b + c$.

   (b) Prove or disprove: if $a - b < c$, then $|a-b| < c$.

   Solution. This statement is **false**. Take $a = 0$, $b = 2$, and $c = 1$. Then $a - b = -2 < 1 = c$, so the hypothesis is true. But $|a-b| = |-2| = 2 \not< 1$. Thus the conclusion is false.

(c) Prove or disprove: if $|a-b| < c$, then $a - b < c$.

Solution. This statement is **true**. By part (a), $|a-b| < c$ implies $b - c < a < b + c$. In particular, $a < b + c$. Subtracting b from both sides gives $a - b < c$.

(d) Prove that $\big||x| - |y|\big| \leq |x + y|$.

Solution. By the triangle inequality,

$$|x| = |(x + y) - y| \leq |x + y| + |y|.$$

Subtracting $|y|$ gives $|x| - |y| \leq |x + y|$. Similarly,

$$|y| = |(x + y) - x| \leq |x + y| + |x|,$$

so $|y| - |x| \leq |x + y|$.

Now there are two cases. If $|x| - |y| \geq 0$, then $\big||x| - |y|\big| = |x| - |y| \leq |x + y|$. If $|x| - |y| < 0$, then $\big||x| - |y|\big| = |y| - |x| \leq |x + y|$.

Therefore $\boxed{\big||x| - |y|\big| \leq |x + y|}$.

Solutions 4: Proof by contradiction

1. Prove that there do not exist integers a and b such that $21a + 30b = 1$.

   Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that there were integers a and b satisfying $21a + 30b = 1$. Both $21a$ and $30b$ are divisible by 3, so their sum is divisible by 3. Thus $3 \mid (21a + 30b)$. But $21a + 30b = 1$, so this would imply that $3 \mid 1$, which is impossible.

   Therefore there are no integers a, b such that $21a + 30b = 1$.

2. Find all positive integers n such that $n^2 - 1$ is prime. Prove that your answer is correct.

   Solution. We factor $n^2 - 1 = (n - 1)(n + 1)$.

   If $n = 1$, then $n^2 - 1 = 0$, which is not prime. If $n = 2$, then $n^2 - 1 = 4 - 1 = 3$, which is prime.

   Now suppose that $n \geq 3$. Then $n - 1 \geq 2$ and $n + 1 \geq 4$. Thus $n^2 - 1$ is a product of two integers greater than 1, so it is not prime.

   Therefore the only positive integer n for which $n^2 - 1$ is prime is $\boxed{n = 2}$.

3. Prove that if x is an integer, then $x^2 + 2$ is not divisible by 4.

   Solution. There are two cases.

   If x is even, then $x = 2k$ for some integer k. Hence

   $$x^2 + 2 = (2k)^2 + 2 = 4k^2 + 2.$$

   If this were divisible by 4, then subtracting $4k^2$ would imply that 2 is divisible by 4, which is false.

   If x is odd, then $x = 2k + 1$ for some integer k. Then

   $$x^2 + 2 = (2k + 1)^2 + 2 = 4k^2 + 4k + 3 = 4(k^2 + k) + 3.$$

   If this were divisible by 4, then subtracting $4(k^2 + k)$ would imply that 3 is divisible by 4, which is false.

   Thus in either case, $\boxed{4 \nmid x^2 + 2}$.

4. Prove that there are no integer solutions to the equation $x^2 - y^2 = 2$.

   Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that integers x and y satisfy $x^2 - y^2 = 2$.

   If x and y have the same parity, then either both are even or both are odd. If both are even, then both x^2 and y^2 are divisible by 4, so $x^2 - y^2$ is divisible by 4 and cannot equal 2.

   If both are odd, write $x = 2r + 1$ and $y = 2s + 1$. Then

   $$x^2 - y^2 = (4r^2 + 4r + 1) - (4s^2 + 4s + 1),$$

   which is divisible by 4, so it cannot equal 2.

   If x and y have different parity, then one of x^2, y^2 is even and the other is odd. Therefore $x^2 - y^2$ is odd, so it cannot equal 2.

   All possibilities lead to a contradiction. Therefore there are no integer solutions.

5. Let a, b, c be integers satisfying $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$. Prove that at least one of a, b, or c is even.

   Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that none of a, b, c is even. Then all three are odd.

   The square of an odd integer is odd, so a^2, b^2, and c^2 are all odd. But $a^2 + b^2$ is the sum of two odd integers, and is therefore even, while c^2 is odd. Thus $a^2 + b^2 \neq c^2$, contradicting the hypothesis.

   Therefore at least one of a, b, c must be even.

6. Suppose that x is a real number such that $0 \leq x \leq \pi/2$. Prove that $\sin x + \cos x \geq 1$.

   Solution. Because $0 \leq x \leq \pi/2$, both $\sin x$ and $\cos x$ are nonnegative, so $\sin x + \cos x \geq 0$.

   Now

   $$\begin{aligned}(\sin x + \cos x)^2 &= (\sin x)^2 + 2 \sin x \cos x + (\cos x)^2 \\ &= 1 + 2 \sin x \cos x.\end{aligned}$$

   Since $\sin x \geq 0$ and $\cos x \geq 0$, we have $2 \sin x \cos x \geq 0$. Hence $(\sin x + \cos x)^2 \geq 1$. Since $\sin x + \cos x$ is nonnegative, it follows that $\boxed{\sin x + \cos x \geq 1}$.

7. Prove that $2^{1/3}$ is irrational.

   Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that $2^{1/3}$ is rational. Then we can write $2^{1/3} = p/q$, where p and q are integers, $q \neq 0$, and p and q have no common divisor other than ± 1.

   Cubing both sides gives

   $$2 = \frac{p^3}{q^3},$$

   so $p^3 = 2q^3$. Thus p^3 is even. If p were odd, then p^3 would be odd, so p must be even. Write $p = 2k$. Substituting gives

   $$(2k)^3 = 2q^3,$$

   so $8k^3 = 2q^3$, and therefore $q^3 = 4k^3$. Thus q^3 is even, so q is even as well.

   Therefore both p and q are even, so they have a common divisor 2. This contradicts our choice of p/q in lowest terms.

   Hence $\boxed{2^{1/3} \text{ is irrational.}}$

8. Suppose that a and n are integers that are both at least 2, and suppose that $a^n - 1$ is prime.

   (a) Prove that $a = 2$.

   Solution. We use the factorization

   $$a^n - 1 = (a - 1)(a^{n-1} + a^{n-2} + \cdots + a + 1).$$

   Because $a \geq 2$ and $n \geq 2$, the second factor is greater than 1.

   Since $a^n - 1$ is prime, it cannot be written as a product of two positive integers that are both greater than 1. Therefore the first factor must equal 1, so $a - 1 = 1$. Hence $\boxed{a = 2}$.

   (b) Prove that n is prime.

   Solution. Suppose, for contradiction, that n is not prime. Since $n \geq 2$, this means that n is composite, so $n = rs$ for some integers $r, s > 1$.

   Then

   $$a^n - 1 = a^{rs} - 1 = (a^r)^s - 1 = (a^r - 1)\left(a^{r(s-1)} + a^{r(s-2)} + \cdots + a^r + 1\right).$$

   Because $a \geq 2$ and $r, s > 1$, both factors are greater than 1. Thus $a^n - 1$ is composite, contradicting the assumption that it is prime.

   Therefore $\boxed{n \text{ is prime.}}$

Solutions 5: Induction

1. Prove that for every positive integer n,

$$1^3 + 2^3 + \cdots + n^3 = \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4}.$$

Solution.

We prove the statement by induction on n.

Base case: Let $n = 1$. Then $1^3 = 1$ and $\frac{1^2(1+1)^2}{4} = 1$. Thus the statement is true when $n = 1$.

Inductive step: Suppose that for some positive integer n, $1^3 + 2^3 + \cdots + n^3 = \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4}$. We must prove that $1^3 + 2^3 + \cdots + n^3 + (n+1)^3 = \frac{(n+1)^2(n+2)^2}{4}$. Using the inductive hypothesis,

$$\begin{aligned} 1^3 + \cdots + n^3 + (n+1)^3 &= \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4} + (n+1)^3 \\ &= (n+1)^2\left(\frac{n^2}{4} + n + 1\right) \\ &= (n+1)^2\left(\frac{n^2+4n+4}{4}\right) \\ &= \frac{(n+1)^2(n+2)^2}{4}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus the statement is true for $n + 1$.

Therefore, by induction, $1^3 + 2^3 + \cdots + n^3 = \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4}$ for every positive integer n.

2. Let a_n be defined recursively by $a_1 = 1$ and $a_n = \sqrt{1 + a_{n-1}}$. Prove that for all positive integers n, $a_n < 2$.

Solution.

We prove the statement by induction on n.

Base case: We have $a_1 = 1 < 2$. *Inductive step:* Suppose that $a_n < 2$. Then $a_{n+1} = \sqrt{1 + a_n} < \sqrt{3}$. Since $\sqrt{3} < 2$, we have $a_{n+1} < 2$. Therefore, by induction, $a_n < 2$ for every positive integer n.

3. Let $F_1, F_2, F_3, \ldots = 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, \ldots$ be the Fibonacci sequence. Prove that

$$F_1^2 + \cdots + F_n^2 = F_n F_{n+1}.$$

Solution.

Recall that the Fibonacci sequence satisfies $F_{n+2} = F_{n+1} + F_n$. We prove the statement by induction on n.

Base case: When $n = 1$, $F_1^2 = 1$ and $F_1 F_2 = 1 \cdot 1 = 1$. Thus the statement is true for $n = 1$.

Inductive step: Suppose that $F_1^2 + \cdots + F_n^2 = F_n F_{n+1}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} F_1^2 + \cdots + F_n^2 + F_{n+1}^2 &= F_n F_{n+1} + F_{n+1}^2 \\ &= F_{n+1}(F_n + F_{n+1}) \\ &= F_{n+1} F_{n+2}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus the statement is true for $n + 1$.

Therefore, by induction, $F_1^2 + \cdots + F_n^2 = F_n F_{n+1}$ for every positive integer n.

4. Prove that $n! > 2^n$ for all $n \geq 4$.

   Solution.

   We prove the statement by induction on n.

   Base case: When $n = 4$, $4! = 24 > 16 = 2^4$. *Inductive step:* Suppose that for some $n \geq 4$, $n! > 2^n$. Then $(n+1)! = (n+1)n! > (n+1)2^n$. Since $n \geq 4$, we have $n + 1 > 2$, and hence $(n+1)2^n > 2 \cdot 2^n = 2^{n+1}$. Therefore $(n+1)! > 2^{n+1}$. Thus, by induction, $n! > 2^n$ for every integer $n \geq 4$.

5. Prove (using induction) that for all integers $n \geq 1$, $2^{2n} - 1$ is divisible by 3.

   Solution.

   We prove the statement by induction on n.

   Base case: When $n = 1$, $2^{2\cdot 1} - 1 = 4 - 1 = 3$, which is divisible by 3.

   Inductive step: Suppose that $3 \mid 2^{2n} - 1$. Thus there exists an integer k such that $2^{2n} - 1 = 3k$. Then

   $$\begin{aligned} 2^{2(n+1)} - 1 &= 4 \cdot 2^{2n} - 1 \\ &= 4(2^{2n} - 1) + 3 \\ &= 4(3k) + 3 \\ &= 3(4k + 1). \end{aligned}$$

   Since $4k + 1$ is an integer, $3 \mid 2^{2(n+1)} - 1$. Therefore, by induction, $3 \mid 2^{2n} - 1$ for every integer $n \geq 1$.

6. *Bernoulli's inequality*: let $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$ be a real number such that $\beta > -1$ and $\beta \neq 0$. Prove that for all integers $n \geq 2$,

   $$(1 + \beta)^n > 1 + n\beta.$$

   Solution.

   We prove the statement by induction on n.

   Base case: When $n = 2$, $(1 + \beta)^2 = 1 + 2\beta + \beta^2$. Since $\beta \neq 0$, we have $\beta^2 > 0$. Therefore $(1 + \beta)^2 > 1 + 2\beta$. *Inductive step:* Suppose that for some $n \geq 2$, $(1 + \beta)^n > 1 + n\beta$. Since $\beta > -1$, we have $1 + \beta > 0$. We may therefore multiply both sides of the inductive hypothesis by $1 + \beta$ without reversing the inequality:

   $$\begin{aligned} (1 + \beta)^{n+1} &> (1 + n\beta)(1 + \beta) \\ &= 1 + (n + 1)\beta + n\beta^2. \end{aligned}$$

   Since $n > 0$ and $\beta \neq 0$, $n\beta^2 > 0$. Therefore $1 + (n+1)\beta + n\beta^2 > 1 + (n+1)\beta$. Thus $(1 + \beta)^{n+1} > 1 + (n+1)\beta$. Therefore, by induction, $(1 + \beta)^n > 1 + n\beta$ for every integer $n \geq 2$.

7. Prove that for all integers $n \geq 1$,

   $$1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \geq \sqrt{n}.$$

   Solution.

   We prove the statement by induction on n.

   Base case: When $n = 1$, $1 = \sqrt{1}$. Thus the statement is true.

   Inductive step: Suppose that $1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \geq \sqrt{n}$. Then

   $$1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}} \geq \sqrt{n} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}}.$$

We claim that $\sqrt{n} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}} \geq \sqrt{n+1}$. Indeed,

$$\begin{aligned}\sqrt{n+1} - \sqrt{n} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1} + \sqrt{n}} \\ &\leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}}.\end{aligned}$$

Therefore $\sqrt{n} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}} \geq \sqrt{n+1}$. It follows that $1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n+1}} \geq \sqrt{n+1}$. Therefore, by induction, $1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \geq \sqrt{n}$ for every integer $n \geq 1$.

8. We prove by induction that

$$|x_1 + x_2 + \cdots + x_n| \leq |x_1| + |x_2| + \cdots + |x_n|.$$

For $n = 1$, we have $|x_1| \leq |x_1|$, so the result is true.

For $n = 2$, the statement is exactly the triangle inequality:

$$|x_1 + x_2| \leq |x_1| + |x_2|.$$

Now suppose that for some $k \geq 2$,

$$|x_1 + \cdots + x_k| \leq |x_1| + \cdots + |x_k|.$$

We want to prove the result for $k + 1$. By the triangle inequality,

$$\begin{aligned}|x_1 + \cdots + x_k + x_{k+1}| &= |(x_1 + \cdots + x_k) + x_{k+1}| \\ &\leq |x_1 + \cdots + x_k| + |x_{k+1}| \\ &\leq |x_1| + \cdots + |x_k| + |x_{k+1}|,\end{aligned}$$

where the first inequality is the triangle inequality, and the last inequality follows from the inductive hypothesis.

Therefore, by induction,

$$\boxed{|x_1 + x_2 + \cdots + x_n| \leq |x_1| + \cdots + |x_n|}$$

for every positive integer n.